Apex Systems

Engineered for scale, secured by design

Response to RFP-2026-017: Supplier Portal and Contract Lifecycle Management Platform
Issued by Meridian Foods Ltd. (fictional)

Requirement summary. Meridian Foods Ltd. requires a cloud-based Supplier Portal and Contract Lifecycle Management (CLM) platform for about 2,500 internal users and 1,200 external suppliers. Mandatory needs: integration with the SAP S/4HANA ERP and corporate single sign-on, workflow-based contract approvals, auditability, data protection aligned with ISO 27001, go-live within 6 months and 3 years of support.

1. Executive Summary and Understanding of the Requirement

Apex Systems proposes a microservices-based Supplier Portal and CLM platform deployed on a dedicated Kubernetes cluster in a regional cloud data centre. We understand that Meridian Foods needs a single system of record for supplier onboarding and contracts, tightly integrated with SAP S/4HANA and corporate identity, and capable of passing external security audits.

Our proposal prioritises technical robustness and security assurance. It is the most engineering-intensive option and is priced accordingly.

2. Proposed Solution and Implementation Approach

Architecture: API-first microservices (contract service, supplier service, workflow engine, document service) behind an API gateway, with PostgreSQL and an event bus for asynchronous processing. Horizontal autoscaling has been load-tested to 10,000 concurrent users, four times the stated requirement.

Integrations: SAP S/4HANA integration uses SAP-certified connectors over OData and IDoc, with a documented mapping for vendor master, purchase order and payment status. SSO is delivered through SAML 2.0 and OpenID Connect against the corporate directory. A REST and webhook API is provided for future systems.

Delivery follows five phases: discovery, architecture and build, integration, hardening and UAT, and phased go-live.

3. Timeline, Team Structure and Milestones

Total duration is 26 weeks from contract signature to production go-live.

- Weeks 1-4: discovery and solution design sign-off
- Weeks 5-14: core platform build and SSO
- Weeks 15-20: SAP integration and data migration
- Weeks 21-24: security hardening, performance test and UAT
- Weeks 25-26: go-live and hypercare

Core team of 11 FTE: engagement manager, solution architect, 5 engineers, 2 QA engineers, security engineer and a DevOps engineer.

4. Commercial Proposal

All prices are in USD, fixed price for the scope described in this document.

Item	Amount (USD)

Platform licence (3 years)	195,000
Implementation and integration services	210,000
Security hardening and penetration test	35,000
Training and documentation	15,000
Support, years 1-3 (premium tier)	30,000
Total three-year cost	**485,000**

Assumptions: up to 2,500 internal users and 1,200 suppliers; one SAP S/4HANA instance; travel excluded; change requests billed at 1,100 USD per day. Prices valid for 90 days.

5. Security, Compliance and Risk Controls

Apex holds ISO 27001:2022 and SOC 2 Type II certifications (reports available under NDA). Data is encrypted with AES-256 at rest and TLS 1.3 in transit, with customer-managed keys optional. Role-based access control, mandatory MFA for administrators and immutable audit logs retained for 7 years are standard. Annual third-party penetration tests are performed and a GDPR data processing agreement is included. Data residency is configurable by region.

Key risks and mitigations: SAP interface complexity (mitigated by early integration spike and certified connectors); schedule pressure on a 26-week plan (mitigated by phased go-live).

6. Support Model, Experience and References

Support is provided during business hours (8x5) with 4-hour response for P1 incidents; 24x7 cover is available as a paid option. A named technical account manager is assigned.

Apex has delivered three comparable CLM and supplier-portal programmes for manufacturing and retail clients over the last four years. References: Harborline Retail (fictional), CTO office; Castell Manufacturing (fictional), Head of Procurement Systems.